Publishing and Sharing in Tableau Assignment

1. What is the key difference between publishing a dashboard on Tableau Public versus Tableau Server/ Cloud in terms of accessibility and data security?

Answer

Tableau public

- Free platform for dashboards
  Tableau Public allows anyone to create, publish, and host interactive dashboards online at no cost. It's ideal for individuals, students, and organizations who want to share data stories without paying for Tableau Server or Cloud.
- Public access
  All dashboards published on Tableau Public are openly available to anyone with an internet connection. There are no restrictions — viewers don't need a Tableau license to interact with the dashboards.
- Supports open data storytelling
- Simple sharing options
- Community and inspiration

Tableau server/cloud

- **Accessibility**: Only people inside your company (or invited users) can see it. They need a username and password to log in.

- **Data Security**: Fully secure. Admins decide exactly who can view, edit, or download each dashboard. Data never becomes public.

- **Used for**: Real business dashboards — sales reports, HR data, financial data things that are private/confidential.

2. **When publishing a Tableau dashboard, what happens to a live connection compared to an extract? How does this affect data refresh and performance?**

Answer

Live connection

Connects directly to the source database.

Live connection update automatically as soon as the sources database changes.

Speed depends entirely on the live processing power of the sources database.

Extract connection

Snapshot of data stored locally in Tableau.

Requires scheduled or manual refresh to show new data.

Highly optimized and faster for complex visualization because data is stored locally.

3. **In Tableau Server or Cloud (conceptually), which feature allows administrators to control which users can view, interact with, or edit published dashboard?**

Answer

Permissions / Content Permissions: This feature allows administrators to implement role-Based Access Control (RBAC) to precisely define who can view, interact, or edit specific dashboards.

4. **If you want users to view a dashboard but not download the underlying data, which permission setting would you adjust in Tableau Server?**

Answer

• **"Download Full Data" Permission**: Denying or unchecking this specific permission capability while leaving "View" allowed ensures users can interact with the dashboard but cannot export the raw underlying dataset.

5. **Name two methods by which a Tableau dashboard can be embedded into a web page or website.**

Answer

Embed Code: Copying and pasting the standard HTML/JavaScript snippet provided by Tableau directly into a web page.

Tableau Embedding API: Using JavaScript/Typescript code to dynamically render, manipulate, and deeply integrate the dashboard within a custom web application.

6. **List two best practices you should follow when preparing a dashboard for public sharing to ensure data security and privacy.**

Answer

Anonymize Data: Remove all Personally Identifiable Information (PII), confidential fields, or internal company metrics before publishing.

Use Extracts and Disable Downloads: Convert data sources into extracts, aggregate the data to the highest required level, and disable the option for users to download the workbook.

7. **After publishing a dashboard, users report a "Data not found" error. What is the most common cause related to data source settings?**

Answer

Missing Credentials or Unreachable File Paths: The published dashboard cannot connect to the backend database because database credentials were not embedded during publishing, or it points to a local file path (like C:/Documents) that the server cannot access.

8. **When embedding a Tableau dashboard into a secure internal portal, what two additional security measures should be implemented to ensure only authorized users can access the embedded content?**

Answer

Single Sign-On (SSO) / SAML: Syncing authentication between the internal portal and Tableau Server so users sign in once securely.

Connected Apps / Token Authentication: Using JSON Web Tokens (JWT) or Trusted tickets to securely authorize and pass the user's identity from the portal to Tableau without exposing credentials**.**

Trusted Authentication (Trusted Tickets)

When your portal wants to show the Tableau dashboard, it first asks Tableau Server for a special "ticket" (like a temporary pass).

Tableau checks if the request is coming from a trusted/approved server (your portal's server).

If yes, it gives a ticket, and the dashboard loads automatically — without asking the user to log in again.